



Step down one notch from the flagships, and you reach the Rs 1.51-to-2.5 lakh segment, where high-end gaming laptops start to look a little more grounded. In 2025, this is where a lot of serious buyers are shopping, because the same generation of CPUs and RTX 50 series GPUs that power the monsters above often appear here in slightly leaner configurations.

Zero1 Winner: **Dell Alienware 16X Aurora AC16251**

The Dell Alienware 16X Aurora AC16251 claims the Zero1 Award by packing near desktop class performance into a 16-inch chassis. With a high-end Intel Core Ultra 9 275HX processor and an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5070, it held its own in this price band across most gaming benchmarks. Its 16-inch display, with fast refresh rate and strong colour reproduction, made the 16X Aurora equally at home in esports titles and cinematic single player games. The brand's vapour chamber cooling, mul-

Gaming laptops (₹151K-250K)

Balanced power, serious play



**Dell Alienware 16X
Aurora AC16251**
Price: ₹2,29,798



ASUS TUF F16 (2025)
Price: ₹1,69,990

iple high airflow fans and well tuned performance profiles kept clocks high during extended sessions, albeit with the kind of fan noise you would expect from a serious gaming rig. It isn't subtle, and it is not cheap, but for those who want the fastest laptop in this segment, this is the machine that set the performance bar in our 2025 tests.

Runner-up and Best Buy: **ASUS TUF F16 (2025)**

The ASUS TUF F16 (2025) pulls off an impressive double, landing as the first runner-up in pure performance while also walking away with the Best Buy title for its value. In our gaming benchmarks, its combination of a high performance Ryzen or Intel processor with an NVIDIA GeForce RTX 5070 class GPU kept it surprisingly close to the Alienware 16X Aurora at QHD, especially once titles became more GPU bound. High refresh 1080p gaming felt effortless, and even at native resolution with settings set to high or very high, frame rates stayed comfortably playable across a wide mix of modern games.

What really stood out was how consistent the TUF F16 felt under sustained load. ASUS's cooling solution, tuned around a more modest power envelope than the Alienware, kept both CPU and GPU temperatures in check without making the laptop unbearably loud. The keyboard delivered a solid, responsive feel with a sensible layout, and the high refresh display offered good colour and contrast for both games and media.

Factor in its significantly lower Indian pricing compared to the Zero1 winner, and the performance per rupee picture becomes clear. For many gamers, the real world difference between the Alienware and the TUF F16 was small enough that it made more sense to put the savings into faster storage, more RAM or a better external monitor. That balance of strong gaming performance, practical thermals and aggressive pricing is what secured the ASUS TUF F16 (2025) its status as both the runner-up in raw speed and this year's Best Buy gaming laptop in the Rs 1.51 to 2.5 lakh segment.

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